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NORTHFIELD HEALTH

Central Venous Catheter Dressing Change Frequency

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Section 2.1 Routine changes

Transparent semi-permeable dressings on central venous catheter sites are changed every 7 days. Gauze dressings are changed every 2 days.

Section 2.2 Immediate changes

A dressing must be changed immediately if it is damp, loose or visibly soiled, regardless of the routine schedule.

Section 2.3 Technique

Hand hygiene is performed before and after dressing care. Sterile gloves and a skin antiseptic are used for each dressing change. The change is documented with date, time and the condition of the insertion site.